



Sweet Notes

A Valentine's Day fundraiser. Students buy a bag of hot chocolate from a stall at break and write an anonymous note to somebody in the school there and then; an adult reads every note, and the bags are delivered on the fourteenth (or the last school day before it). It gets students thinking about who might need a good morning, not just the people they already sit with.

Before you start. An adult reads every note before it goes on a bag and sets aside anything unkind; anonymous means the writer is not named, not that nobody checks. An adult also holds the money. Decide which charity you are raising for before the assembly.

Print these

Page	What it is	How many
Page 2	What to buy, and when to do it	One, for you
Page 3	What goes in a bag, and how it is tied	One for the packing session
Page 4	The notes	Six to a sheet; one note per bag sold
Tracker	The order tracker (a separate download)	Kept by whoever runs the stall

How it works

Step	What happens	Slides
1	Run the assembly. The slides end with your dates, place, price and charity, so edit anything in square brackets first.	1 to 11
2	Open the stall at break for a week. Students pay, name who the bag is for and their form, and write the note there and then. Log each order in the tracker as you take it.	
3	Read every note before it goes on a bag.	
4	Make up the bags. The students running the event do this themselves in one session a day or two before. Page 3 shows what goes in.	
5	Sort the bags by form using the tracker the night before, then deliver them first thing on the 14th.	

Worth knowing

- The student council can run nearly all of this: the shopping, the stall, the packing and the early start.
- Hot chocolate powder contains milk and often soy, and standard marshmallows contain pork gelatine, so buy vegetarian or halal ones. Keep an empty packet of each so a form tutor can check against the allergy register.

Someone in every form is going to have a much better morning because of a minute of somebody else's time.





What to buy, and when to do it

Quantities are per 100 bags. Scale them to whatever you think you will sell, and buy a little over rather than under.

The shopping list

What	Roughly how much	Worth knowing
Small food bags	100, self-seal, about 10 x 15cm	Clear ones look better than opaque. Self-seal saves tying two knots.
Hot chocolate powder	About 1.5kg, or two large tubs	Two heaped teaspoons a bag. Check the label: most contain milk and many contain soy.
Mini marshmallows	Two large bags	Buy vegetarian or halal ones. Standard marshmallows are made with pork gelatine.
Thin ribbon	About 30 metres	Roughly 30cm a bag, to gather the top and hold the note.
Card for the notes	17 sheets of A4	The template on page 4 prints six to a sheet. 160gsm if you have it.
A hole punch	One	One hole in the corner of each note, for the ribbon.
Trays or boxes	One per year group	For sorting the packed bags by form at the end of the packing session.
A float	Small change	If you are taking cash at the stall, start the day with change ready.

Allergies and ingredients. Hot chocolate powder contains milk and often soy, and is frequently made alongside nuts. Buy vegetarian or halal marshmallows so students who avoid pork gelatine can eat them. Keep one empty packet of each so a form tutor can check the ingredients against the allergy register before anything is handed out.

A rough timetable

When	What needs doing
Four weeks out	Agree the price, the stall dates and where any profit goes. Book the assembly and the stall space.
Three weeks out	Buy everything on the list. Print the notes. Open the tracker and fill in the Start here tab.
Two weeks out	Run the assembly, then open the stall the same day while it is fresh.
One week out	Close orders a few days before the 14th. Read the notes as they come in, not all at once.
The day before	The packing session: make up every bag, tie on the notes, and sort by form using the tracker.
The 14th	Deliver to forms before registration, ticking each one off in the tracker.





What goes in a bag

The students running it make these up themselves, a day or two before.



- 1 Two heaped teaspoons of hot chocolate powder.
- 2 A sprinkle of mini marshmallows, vegetarian or halal.
- 3 Gather the top and tie it with about 30cm of ribbon.
- 4 Punch a hole in the note and tie it on with the same ribbon.

Set up a line. Fill the bags before you tie anything. One person spooning powder, one on marshmallows, one tying ribbon and one attaching notes is far quicker than everyone making a whole bag each.



The notes

Six to a sheet. Cut along the lines and punch one hole in the top corner for the ribbon.

SWEET NOTES To: From: Anonymous	SWEET NOTES To: From: Anonymous
SWEET NOTES To: From: Anonymous	SWEET NOTES To: From: Anonymous
SWEET NOTES To: From: Anonymous	SWEET NOTES To: From: Anonymous